



Our Climate Goals

- Every day I **bring my best** to my work and my team.
- I build a safe environment by **welcoming, accepting and respecting** everyone in our community.
- We **hustle to delight** each guest with the convenience they crave.
- We earn the trust of our guests and each other by always **doing what's right**.
- I **embrace change** and welcome the future with creativity and courage.
- We work **together as partners** pursuing common goals and shared success.
- We **listen to understand** each other.
- I invite, share and act on **feedback** to continuously learn and improve.
- I recognize, **celebrate** and take pride in our big and small wins.



DHG House Rules and Policies

Scheduling and Hours

1. All employees must enter through the main front doors, always.
2. Your shift begins 5 minutes before your scheduled time. This means that you must be in full uniform with a working pen (If you do not have a pen one will be provided for you at the cost of \$1), and ready to go 5 minutes before your shift begins. And you may be required to stay up to 30 minutes extra (paid) if/when needed.
3. Any employee arriving at the restaurant early for their shift must wait quietly in the designated staff area of the dining room until 10 minutes before their shift starts. Any loitering around the A&W building outside of your shift time is not allowed either in uniform or not.
4. All day(s) off requests must be sent in an email to the store email address with "DAY OFF REQUEST" in the subject line, at least two weeks in advance. Time off is given on a first come, first served basis and we can NOT guarantee time off.
5. All employees may be scheduled to work for any statutory holiday if the restaurant is open. NO statutory holidays will be automatically given unless it falls during approved vacation time. Requested vacations will be accepted/rejected based on business needs.
6. Every employee must take off one-week vacation in each DHG-defined vacation zone. The vacation zones are defined as January – March, and June – August. Any additional vacations must be requested in writing to the store email address.
7. If you are sick, please call in on the restaurant phone number in as soon as possible either the night before or first thing in the morning (minimum 5 hrs notice, emergencies exempted). And, under certain circumstances, you may be required to supply a doctor's note. Calling in sick to a Manager's personal phone number will not be accepted. The first two sick calls in an annual year will be counted as your paid PEL days.
8. If you need your schedule changed due to unforeseen circumstances, please bring it to the manager or supervisor's attention and they will do their best to accommodate you. Only management may change the schedule. All schedule changes should be kept to a very minimum.
9. It is your responsibility to know your schedule. Not knowing your schedule is not an excuse for missing your shift.
10. Please let your family members know what time you are finishing before you leave the house. We do not want family members calling the restaurant to find out what time you are finishing.
11. You must clock in and out on the cash registers yourself. It is not permitted to clock another employee in or out.

Food & Discounts

12. Any expired food must be thrown into the corresponding waste bins immediately and is not to be consumed by employees.
13. Any non- A&W food or drinks must not be eaten or placed in the restaurant dining room or front patio.
14. Employees will receive an employee discount on all food purchases, except for bulk chicken orders. NO CREDIT. * NOTE: the above discount does not apply to retail items, bulk chicken and 2L pop. A VIP discount will be applied on retail items, and 2L pop and bulk chicken.
15. Food must be prepared and served by another employee
16. Every employee discount receipt must be signed by the employee receiving the discount, and the MOD issuing the discount.
17. Employees are entitled to promotional discounts (i.e. 2 Teens for \$6 etc) or employee discount not both.
18. No glass mugs are allowed in the kitchen area. Front staff is to drink in the specified area at the back and return promptly to their position.
19. If you take and eat food of any kind, including French-fries, kids treats, stale items, items returned by customer, that you have not paid for disciplinary actions will be taken and may result in termination
20. No chewing gum, eating food or smoking while on duty. If you need a smoke break please see policy #42.
21. Everything must be punched in before it is made by the kitchen.

Uniform & Accessories

22. There are strict uniform, nail, hair, and facial hair and jewelry policies in place. Please check with Management to comply with these policies.
23. Undershirts should only be visible at the collar and nowhere else and should be plain black or white only.
24. While on shift, cell phones must not be on the employee, they must be left in locker or car. And absolutely no iPods, MP3 players or headphones.
25. All employees are required to wear a hairnet while on their shift.
26. All employees on shift must wear black, vinyl or leather, non-slip, water and oil resistant shoes. Shoes must have a "Tread Safe", "Safe Step" seal on the sole.
27. Uniforms must be clean and ironed. Management will evaluate uniforms on a regular basis; if the uniform's condition is determined to be unacceptable you MUST purchase a new one and are hereby authorizing my employer to deduct the total from my pay cheque.

Work ethic & behavior

28. The store phone is a business phone and should not be used for personal calls unless it is an emergency. Receiving and making personal calls is prohibited.
29. All employees must follow the level charts posted when doing their jobs unless otherwise specified by management.
30. Every cashier is required to up-sell each and every time they take an order.
31. There is never a reason to be idle. Look for things to clean and polish and restock and keep your work area tidy when possible.
32. All deliveries must be checked for accuracy before being placed away
33. Discrimination, harassment, and violence in the work place are illegal and will not be tolerated, in any form!
34. No rude, foul language and no drugs or alcohol on premises is allowed on premises under any circumstances.

Pay & Breaks

35. Payday will be on the 15th and last day of every month (or, previous business day if falling on a weekend or any banking holiday), covering pay from the 1st to 15th, and 16th to the end of the month, respectively.
36. Your last pay cheque will always be in the form of a paper cheque which you must pick up from the store. Your ROE will be automatically mailed to you.
37. When turning 18 years old it is the employee's responsibility to make sure he/she has informed the management that he/she is now the age of majority.

38. All employees, including all management, must take the legally required breaks. The purpose is to ensure that we have a policy in place, which is fair to all employees and follows the employment standards legislation of the Government of Ontario. It is also designed to ensure that the hours-one 30 minute break (not paid) Over 10.5 hours-two 30 minute breaks (unpaid)
39. Washroom and cigarette breaks are only to be taken during scheduled breaks. If you require another break, you may ask for an additional 15-minute (unpaid) break; which will be permitted if business allows.
40. A shift is defined as those continuous hours an employee may be scheduled. A split-shift, when an employee is off more than 1 hour between shifts, will be considered as two separate shifts.

Day to day procedures & policies

41. When going from the front to the kitchen please make sure that you wash your hands before entering the kitchen
42. There should be no talking between the front and kitchen employees that does not have to do with an order
43. Please make sure that when you do the required cleaning in the front and kitchen to make sure you put your number on the charts.
44. Customers requesting extra cheese on their poutine must be charged for extra cheese curds not regular cheese.
45. Customers requesting extra gravy can be given one free scoop, if they want two scoops, charge them for a side small gravy. Do not leave cooler and freezer doors open even if you are going back for something, close it and open it again.
46. Label EVERYTHING with a date, time, name, and item description.
47. Anything going in the chute for hold should be numbered with the chute timers.
48. Please ask management which position you will be working for your shift. This cannot be changed without management's knowledge.
49. Each box must be broken and flattened before being thrown away by both front and back persons.
50. Front and back closers are responsible for their equipment being put away. All sinks should be left clean.
51. If your shift begins or falls over lunch time or dinner time, please eat before coming to work.
52. Any phoned in customer complaints must be dealt with by management only.
53. When answering the store phone, make sure you give a full greeting including your name and the location. (e.g., "Thank you for calling A&W Heartland, Priya speaking, How can I help you?").

Cashier policies

54. All cashiers are responsible for getting the required signatures on discount cancel and void receipts from the Manager on Duty and the employee obtaining the discount
55. You must keep ALL your debit, discount (including open discount), cancel and void receipts
56. Cashiers cannot accept US currency, or Canadian \$100 bills.
57. All credit card signatures must be verified against the back of the credit card
58. Drive thru orders should not get napkins in the bag, napkins MUST be handed to the customer separately
59. All drive thru cashiers must ask if the customer wants ketchup in the bag. Please make sure to punch it in if they do.
60. When packing an order, make sure you are using the right size bag for the meal you are packing (a packed bag should have a fold of about an inch).
61. Please make sure you are only giving out one dipping sauce for 3 and 5 strips, only if the customer asks will we give a second one for the 5 strips.
62. Additional dipping sauces can be given out in the following ratio: 1 per side (fries, onion rings etc) item. Any extra dipping sauces should be charged for.
63. All orders get 1 napkin per combo/burger. If a customer asks for more napkins always give them only 1-2 more at first, then an additional 1-2 more if they request even more. If a customer asks for "a lot" of napkins, give them four.
64. When someone orders a tea, you have to ask them what size they would like, even though there is only 1 price for it on the till.
65. We only have one size of hot chocolate so if a customer wants bigger size, charge them for two and serve it in large coffee cup with 4 packages of hot chocolate powder.
66. The drive thru window should not be left open at any time.
67. No lollipops should only be packed with the kids pack when we are out of kid treats. In this case, two lollipops may substitute the kid treat.
68. All cashiers please follow the timers in the chute when running food.
69. Front openers please make sure that the ketchup pump is filled to the top in the morning, not halfway.
70. Front openers must make sure the outside of the restaurant is clean and have the outside garbage changed by 9:00 am if it is more than half full.
71. When cleaning the dining room, remember "TABLES, MUGS... THEN TRAYS!" If you are seen doing trays, it means the dining room tables and mug collection bins are clean. Also, always check dining room garbage for trays that have been thrown into them by customers. Keep your surrounding neat and tidy. Receipts should be put in the till as soon as possible

Kitchen Policies

72. Make sure that when you are grabbing items from the stock are to be careful and try not to drop a whole bunch on the floor, and if you do please pick it up right away
73. When stocking up the bags please make sure that you put the bags correctly and all the same way
74. Please make sure that you wash your hands every time you touch raw meat, chicken grills, wieners, veggies, etc. Also wash your hand every time you touch a broom, the garbage, your face, your pockets, etc.
75. There should be no talking when there are orders on the screen
76. Always use your hold and cook timers each time something is cooked.
77. When doing backup, use lids before resorting to plastic wrap and follow the backup chart.
78. When removing bread trays from the kitchen they should be taken straight outside and not left near the backdoor.
79. Do not pressure-cook beef patties as it will dry them out and burn them. Only searing is permitted for beef patties.

Overnight policies

80. Do not go outside (e.g., to clean, take out garbage, baskets or oil etc.) between 11pm-7am. Use buddy system once it is dark.
81. If there is a wait on an order (once dining room is closed) DO NOT take the food out to a parked car, request the customer to drive back around (tell the customer how long it will take and when they should drive back around).
82. Lock all doors. This also means do not leave drive thru window open, do not open doors for any unauthorized person once dining room is closed and make sure the back door is locked at all times.
83. In case of an unfortunate incident of robbery, just hand over the money. Don't try and be brave. If at any time there is danger to your safety, CALL THE POLICE at once.

***If any policies are not followed disciplinary action will be taken, which may result in termination.**

****The above policies negate all previous policies outlined by Management and are the sole policies employees must adhere to. All store policies are subject to change, and it is your responsibility to view the new policies posted in store.**

Workplace Health and Safety Policy 2026

We are very concerned and interested in the Health and Safety of employees. Protection of employees from injury or occupational disease is a continuing objective. We will make all reasonable efforts to provide a safe, healthy work environment. Employees and managers share an ongoing responsibility for worker Health and Safety. We strive to reduce the risk of fire and other property damage and to comply with all applicable legislation.

Procedure

- Management will be held accountable for the Health and Safety of workers under their supervision. Management is responsible to ensure that machinery and equipment are safe and that employees work in compliance with established safe work practices and procedures. Employees must receive adequate training in their specific work tasks to protect their Health and Safety.
- Management is required to ensure health and safety meetings occur as required by legislation.
- Every employee must protect his or her own Health and Safety by working in compliance with the law and with safe work practices and procedures established by the company. Employees must report to work mentally and physically fit, rested and free from the effects of drugs and alcohol.
- Employees must notify managers of any health and safety concerns, so that they may be dealt with promptly. Employees must report any injuries sustained at work that require either first aid or health care to their supervisor immediately.
- Employees should not report to work if they have an infectious disease, wound, are vomiting or have diarrhea. They should contact management as soon as it becomes apparent that they should not report to work.
- It is in the best interest of all parties to consider Health and Safety in every activity. Commitment to Health and Safety is an integral part of this restaurant.

December 2026 - The franchisor A&W Inc. has provided suggested form letters to assist the franchisee when the appropriate circumstance should arise. The use of such form letters is not mandatory nor does it necessarily meet the strict legal requirement applicable in every individual circumstance. It is intended as a guideline for the franchisee's convenience and not as a required action.

Discrimination, Harassment, Bullying and Violence in the Workplace Policy

2026

Employees are expected to treat one another with mutual respect, and must commit to fostering a work atmosphere free of discrimination, harassment, bullying, and violence. Acts of workplace discrimination, harassment, bullying, or violence against or by any employee are prohibited. It is also a violation of this policy for anyone to knowingly make a false complaint of discrimination, harassment, bullying, or violence, or to provide false information about a complaint.

A&W is an equal opportunity employer and commits to ensuring every employee and candidate for employment is free from discrimination within employment or prospective employment. This applies to all phases of the employment relationship including but not limited to promotion, demotion, discipline, layoff, termination, compensation, selection and training.

Definitions

- ***Bullying:*** Any inappropriate conduct or comment by a person towards another worker that the person knew or ought to have known would cause that worker to be humiliated or intimidated. This includes cyberbullying - bullying behaviour electronically. This excludes any reasonable action taken to supervise or direct workers in the performance of their duties.
- ***Discrimination:*** Treating someone differently based on their personal characteristics: race, ancestry, place of origin, colour, ethnic origin, citizenship, religion, creed, sex, gender identity, age, record of offences, marital status, family status, disability, sexual preference, pregnancy, or other protected ground. Discrimination is prohibited by human rights legislation.
- ***Harassment:*** A course of vexatious comments or conduct against an employee that is known or ought reasonably to be known to be unwelcome. This includes sexual harassment, inappropriate physical conduct, and acts that create an intimidating, offensive, degrading, humiliating, or hostile work environment. It excludes any reasonable action taken to supervise or direct workers in the performance of their duties.
- ***Sexual Harassment:*** Harassment against an employee on the basis of sex, sexual orientation, gender identity, or gender expression. This includes making a sexual solicitation or advance in cases where the person making the solicitation or advance is in a position to confer, grant, or deny a benefit or advancement to the employee, and the person knows or ought reasonably to know that the solicitation or advance is unwelcome.
- ***Violence:*** The use or attempted use of physical force against an employee that could cause physical injury. This includes a statement or behaviour that an employee could reasonably interpret as a threat to use physical force against him or her that could cause physical injury. It also includes domestic violence that occurs in the workplace.

Requirements

- ***Prohibited Actions:*** The following are examples of behaviour prohibited in the workplace:
 - Bullying
 - Workplace violence or harassment, including workplace sexual harassment
 - Any

threat or intimidation

- Possession of a weapon of any kind on the company's property
- Assault or other acts of hostility or aggression
- Dangerous or threatening horseplay
- Retaliation against anyone who has made a complaint or participated in an investigation
- Any other act considered by the company to be a violation of this policy, whether or not specifically set out above

➤ **Sanctions:** Those who violate this policy are subject to disciplinary and/or corrective action, up to and including termination of employment for cause.

➤ **Safety measures:** Employees are strongly encouraged to:

- Remove themselves from any immediate danger
- Contact emergency services where appropriate (police, ambulance)
- Follow all policies, practices, and procedures regarding safety in the workplace
- Immediately inform management about any safety risks in the workplace
- Become familiar with the location of all building exits
- Use common sense
- Be alert to their surroundings

➤ **Reporting complaints and incidents**

- An employee who is a victim of harassment, bullying, discrimination, or violence by another employee may inform the wrongdoer in clear terms that the wrongdoer's comments or conduct is unwelcome and will not be tolerated. If the employee is not comfortable doing so because of the nature of the situation, or if the harassment, bullying, discrimination, or violence continues, the employee alleging these prohibited acts must report the problem to his or her manager. If the manager is the source of the problem, the report must be made to the next level of management or the franchisee.
- Any situation of domestic violence that may spill over into the workplace and/or may present a danger to an employee in the workplace must also be reported by the employee to his or her manager and the franchisee.
- Threats or assaults of a serious nature must be reported to the local police. If an incident causes the employee to fear for his or her safety or for the safety of any other person, the employee must call 9-1-1 immediately, and then notify his or her manager as soon as possible about the incident.

➤ **Investigation of Complaints and Incidents**

- Incidents or complaints covered by this policy must be investigated promptly and objectively, and in a manner appropriate to the circumstances. An independent resource may be requested to participate.
- The investigation process typically involves the following steps:
 - Review of the complaint
 - Interviews of the complainant, potential witnesses, and the subject of the complaint
 - Collection and review of documents
 - Review of the worksite
 - Decision as to whether this policy has been violated

- Information to the complainant and the subject of the complaint (if these persons are employees of the company) as to the outcome of the investigation
- Information gathered during the investigation, including identifying information about any person involved, must not be disclosed unless required by law or necessary to facilitate the investigation and/or take corrective action.
- **No Retaliation:** There must be no retaliation against anyone who makes a bona fide report of harassment, discrimination, bullying, threats, or violence. Retaliation by another employee is strictly prohibited.

applicable in every individual circumstance. It is intended as a guideline for the franchisee's convenience and not as a required action.

A&W Accessible Workplace Policy 2026

A&W is committed to improving accessibility. We will put the following policies into practice as required by the Accessibility for Ontarians with Disabilities Act.

General

- A&W is committed to training staff on Ontario's accessibility laws and on accessibility aspects of the Human Rights Code that apply to persons with disabilities.
- Training will be provided in a way that best suits the duties of employees, volunteers and other staff members.

Information and Communications

- A&W is committed to meeting the communication needs of people with disabilities. ➤ When asked, we will provide information and communications materials in accessible formats or with communication supports.
- This includes publicly available information about our goods, services and facilities, as well as publicly available emergency information.

Employment

- A&W will notify the public and staff that, when requested, we will accommodate disabilities during recruitment and assessment processes and when people are hired.
- If needed, we will provide customized workplace emergency information to employees who have a disability.
- If using performance management, career development and redeployment processes, we will take into account the accessibility needs of employees with disabilities.

Design of Public Spaces

A&W will meet the Accessibility Standards for the Design of Public Spaces when building or making major modifications to public spaces. Public spaces include:

- Recreational trails/beach access routes
- Accessible off street parking
- Service-related elements like service counters, fixed queuing lines and waiting areas

Modifications to this or Other Policies

- Any of our policies that do not respect and promote the dignity and independence of people with disabilities will be modified or removed.

December 2026 - The franchisor A&W Inc. has provided suggested form letters to assist the franchisee when the appropriate circumstance should arise. The use of such form letters is not mandatory nor does it necessarily meet the strict legal requirement applicable in every individual circumstance. It is intended as a guideline for the franchisee's convenience and not as a required action.

Customer Service Standard Policy 2026

We strive at all times to provide our products in a way that respects the dignity and independence of people with disabilities. We are also committed to giving people with disabilities the same opportunity to access our goods and services and allowing them to benefit from the same services, in the same place and in a similar way as other customers.

Communication

Our Employees will communicate with people with disabilities in ways that take into account their disability. We will train staff who communicate with customers on how to interact and communicate with people with various types of disabilities.

Use of Service Animals and Support Persons

We welcome people with disabilities who are accompanied by a service animal on the parts of our premises that are open to the public and other third parties. We will also ensure that all staff, volunteers and others dealing with the public are properly trained in how to interact with people with disabilities who are accompanied by a service animal.

We are committed to welcoming people with disabilities who are accompanied by a support person. Any person with a disability who is accompanied by a support person will be allowed to enter the premises with his or her support person. At no time will a person with a disability who is accompanied by a support person be prevented from having access to his or her support person while on our premises.

Notice of Temporary Disruption

We will provide customers with notice in the event of a planned or unexpected disruption in the facilities or services usually used by people with disabilities. This notice will include information about the reason for the disruption, its anticipated duration, and a description of alternative facilities or services, if available.

The notice will be placed at all public entrances and service counters on our premises.

Training for Staff

The Company will provide training to all employees who deal with the public and all those who are involved in the development and approval of customer service policies, practices and procedures. This training will be provided as part of the New Employee Training (NET) and will be completed within the first month of employment.

Training will include the following:

- *The purposes of the Accessibility for Ontarians with Disabilities Act, 2005 and the requirements of the customer service standard*
- *How to interact and communicate with people with various types of disabilities* ➤

How to interact with people with disabilities who use an assistive device or require the assistance of a service animal or a support person

- *How to use the [name equipment or devices , e.g. TTY, wheelchair lifts, etc., available on provider's premises or otherwise that may help with the provision of goods or services to people with disabilities]*
- *What to do if a person with a disability is having difficulty in accessing the our services*

Applicable staff will be trained on policies, practices and procedures that affect the way goods and services are provided to people with disabilities. Staff will also be trained on an ongoing basis when changes are made to these policies, practices and procedures.

Feedback Process

Feedback regarding the way we provide goods and services to people with disabilities can be made via:

- Email
- In-person
- Telephone
- Letter
- Website

All feedback will be directed to Priya Dhillon (President). Customers can expect to hear back in 2 days.

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Fitness for Work Policy 2026

Policy Intent

This policy supports the company's commitment to do its part in maintaining a safe and healthy work environment.

Policy Statement

Employees are expected to be fit for work when reporting to their job and to remain fit for the duration of the working day.

Definitions

Fitness for Work: The state in which individuals are in a physical, mental, and emotional condition that enables them to perform their assigned duties effectively and in a manner that does not have a negative impact on themselves or others.

Requirements

➤ *Responsibilities of Employees*

- Employees must not consume alcohol or recreational marijuana on company premises or in company vehicles
- They must not be in possession of or use any illicit drugs company premises, in company vehicles, or at company-sponsored events
- If required to take prescription medicine which could impair their ability to safely carry out their work, employees should advise their supervisor
- Manage factors that may have an impact on their ability to perform the required work unimpaired and to the full extent of their capability
- Disclose, to their immediate supervisor or Restaurant Manager, information about any factors that may impact their ability to perform work safely. This is especially important for those whose jobs involve activities which could have a significant impact on their own or others' safety
- Ensure that their judgment and performance at work (including the operation of company vehicles) are never impaired by intoxicating substances, including alcohol and marijuana
- If in need of assistance with health challenges that may affect their fitness for work, discuss these concerns with their immediate supervisor and/or Restaurant Manager. ➤

Enforcement: If there is reason to believe that an employee's job performance is being affected negatively by his or her use of intoxicating substances, the company has the right to inquire as to the nature of the problem and to take appropriate action, which may include disciplinary action up to and including termination of employment.

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In case of injury or illness at work

1

Get medical help

Your employer is responsible for providing first aid. See a doctor or go to a hospital if you need treatment. Your employer pays for your transportation on the day of injury.

2

Document

Tell your employer about your injury or illness. They keep a record of what happened.

3

Report to the WSIB

You can scan the QR code below or visit wsib.ca/reporting and follow the steps to submit a Worker's Report of Injury/Illness (Form 6). Your employer must report an injury or illness to us within three business days.

4

Work together

We work with you and your employer to help you recover and return to work safely, at the right time.



Scan the QR code or visit wsib.ca/reporting to submit a Worker's Report of Injury/Illness (Form 6).

Questions? We're here to help.

Sign up for our online services to send us a message anytime, anywhere, or call us at 1-800-387-0750 or TTY: 1-800-387-0050.

Visit wsib.ca/online services for details.



Health & Safety at Work

➤ Prevention Starts Here

Ontario's Occupational Health and Safety Act gives workers rights. It sets out roles for employers, supervisors and workers so they can work together to make workplaces safer.

➤ Improve Health and Safety:

- Find out about your Joint Health and Safety Committee or Health and Safety Representative.
- Talk to your employer, supervisor, workers, joint health and safety committee or health and safety representative about health and safety concerns.

Call the Ministry of Labour,
Training and Skills Development
at 1-877-202-0008

Report critical injuries, fatalities,
work refusals anytime.

Workplace health and safety information,
weekdays 8:30am – 5:00pm.

Emergency? Always call 911 immediately.

Find out more:

ontario.ca/healthandsafetyatwork



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➤ Workers have the right to:

- Know about workplace hazards and what to do about them.
- Participate in solving workplace health and safety problems.
- Refuse work they believe is unsafe.

➤ Workers must:

- Follow the law and workplace health and safety policies and procedures.
- Wear and use the protective equipment required by their employer.
- Work and act in a way that won't hurt themselves or anyone else.
- Report any hazards or injuries to their supervisor.

Employers must NOT take action against workers for following the law and raising health and safety concerns.

➤ Employers must:

- Make sure workers know about hazards and dangers by providing information, instruction and supervision on how to work safely.
- Make sure supervisors know what is required to protect workers' health and safety on the job.
- Create workplace health and safety policies and procedures.
- Make sure everyone follows the law and the workplace health and safety policies and procedures.
- Make sure workers wear and use the right protective equipment.
- Do everything reasonable in the circumstances to protect workers from being hurt or getting a work-related illness.

➤ Supervisors must:

- Tell workers about hazards and dangers, and respond to their concerns.
- Show workers how to work safely, and make sure they follow the law and workplace health and safety policies and procedures.
- Make sure workers wear and use the right protective equipment.
- Do everything reasonable in the circumstances to protect workers from being hurt or getting a work-related illness.

Employment Standards in Ontario

The *Employment Standards Act, 2000* (ESA) protects employees and sets minimum standards for most workplaces in Ontario. Employers are prohibited from penalizing employees in any way for exercising their rights under the ESA.

What you need to know

Public holidays

Ontario has a number of public holidays each year. Most employees are entitled to take these days off work and be paid public holiday pay. Visit [Ontario.ca/publicholidays](https://ontario.ca/publicholidays).

Hours of work and overtime

There are daily and weekly limits on hours of work. There are also rules around meal breaks, rest periods and overtime. Visit [Ontario.ca/hoursofwork](https://ontario.ca/hoursofwork) and [Ontario.ca/overtime](https://ontario.ca/overtime).

Termination notice and pay

In most cases when terminating employment, employers must give employees advance written notice of termination or termination pay instead of notice. Visit [Ontario.ca/terminationofemployment](https://ontario.ca/terminationofemployment).

Vacation time and pay

There are rules around the amount of vacation time and pay employees earn. Most employees can take vacation time after every 12 months of work. Visit [Ontario.ca/vacation](https://ontario.ca/vacation).

Leaves of absence

There are a number of job-protected leaves of absence in Ontario. Examples include sick leave, pregnancy leave, parental leave and family caregiver leave. Visit [Ontario.ca/ESAguide](https://ontario.ca/ESAguide).

Minimum wage

Most employees are entitled to be paid at least the minimum wage. For current rates visit [Ontario.ca/minimumwage](https://ontario.ca/minimumwage).

Other employment rights, exemptions and special rules

There are other rights, exemptions and special rules not listed on this poster, including rights to severance pay and special rules for assignment employees of temporary help agencies.

Subscribe to our newsletter and stay up to date on the latest news that can affect you and your workplace. Visit [Ontario.ca/labournews](https://ontario.ca/labournews).

Learn more about your rights at:

[Ontario.ca/employmentstandards](https://ontario.ca/employmentstandards)
1-800-531-5551 or TTY 1-866-567-8893

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Ministry of Labour, Immigration, Training and Skills Development

Your Rights Under the Employment Protection for Foreign Nationals Act, 2009

Disclaimer: This resource has been prepared to help employees and employers understand some of the minimum rights and obligations established under the *Employment Protection for Foreign Nationals Act, 2009* (EPFNA) and regulations. It is not legal advice. It is not intended to replace the EPFNA or regulations and reference should always be made to the official version of the legislation. Although we endeavor to ensure that the information in this resource is as current and accurate as possible, errors do occasionally occur. The EPFNA provides minimum standards only. Some employees may have greater rights under an employment contract, collective agreement, the common law or other legislation.

The [Employment Protection for Foreign Nationals Act, 2009](#) (EPFNA) is a law that provides rights and protections for foreign nationals who work or are seeking work in Ontario under an immigration or foreign temporary employee program, like the federal Temporary Foreign Worker Program. For more information, please visit Ontario.ca/EPFNA.

This information sheet provides a summary of your rights under the EPFNA. If your first language is not English, your recruiter or employer must provide this information sheet to you in your first language, if it is available from the Ministry of Labour, Immigration, Training and Skills Development.

As a foreign national working in Ontario, you generally also have rights under the [Employment Standards Act, 2000](#) (ESA). The ESA sets minimum standards for most workplaces in Ontario, including minimum wage and limits on hours of work. Your employer must also give you an information sheet about your rights under the ESA.

A recruiter cannot charge you any fee

A recruiter is anyone who finds or tries to find you employment in Ontario. A recruiter may also refer you to someone or help someone find you employment in Ontario. Your recruiter or someone working with them, cannot charge you any fees for any service, good or benefit provided to you, such as: a Labour Market Assessment, orientation, resume writing services, interview preparation or first aid training.

An employer cannot recover costs of you becoming an employee (with some exceptions)

Generally, your employer cannot charge you for any fees or costs it paid for hiring you, such as your Labour Market Assessment, orientation, training or fees it paid to a recruiter. It also can't deduct these fees or costs from your wages. However, if you are employed under the federal government's Seasonal Agricultural Worker Program (SAWP), your employer can deduct the costs of air travel and work permits if your SAWP employment contract allows this.

An employer also cannot recover recruitment fees or other placement costs from a foreign national on behalf of a recruiter.

A recruiter or employer cannot take your property

Your recruiter, your employer, or a person acting for them cannot take or hold onto your property for any reason. This includes documents such as your passport or work permit.

You cannot agree to give up your rights

You cannot agree or sign a contract to give up any of your rights under the EPFNA. These agreements or contracts are invalid. For example, if you sign a contract allowing a recruiter to charge you a recruitment fee, this agreement would be invalid.

You cannot be punished for asking about or exercising your rights

If you ask about your rights or exercise your rights under the EPFNA or ESA, your recruiter or employer cannot threaten, intimidate or punish you in any way, including by ending your employment.

If you have a question or want to file a claim

For more information the EPFNA, please visit Ontario.ca/EPFNA.

If you have questions about the EPFNA you may also call the Employment Standards Information Centre at (416) 326-7160, toll-free at 1-800-531-5551, or TTY 1-866-567-8893. Information is available in many languages.

If you believe you have not received your rights under the EPFNA, you can file a claim with the Ministry of Labour, Immigration, Training and Skills Development at Ontario.ca/EPFNA.

You have three and a half years to file a claim for your rights under the EPFNA.